DONALD B. HAVERY

Intelligence Manager

Applied AI · Forward Deployed Engineering · AI Operations · Operations and logistics background

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Scan for the portfolio

SUMMARY

I determine which work AI should handle, build the systems, and report what they cost and what they return. I have built AI agents that run in production with the controls they require: tool calling, release tests that fail the build on regression, cost and step limits, and handoffs to a person with the reason recorded. I work with the people who perform each job to decide which steps an agent should take. My background includes training new drivers as a company-certified trainer at Peninsula Truck Lines, supervising staff at several employers, operating my own businesses with full profit-and-loss responsibility, and current work as a line-haul driver at Old Dominion Freight Line. I am seeking this role within a single large company.

MEASURED RESULTS

- **Quality.** On a 71-question test of my live customer-service agent, cut wrong answers from 3 to 0. Of the 23 cases still handed to a person, 21 were policy the business had not yet decided, so I listed them as open decisions for the business.
- **Risk.** Took my production agent offline when it answered questions the business had not decided, and turned it back on only after each new guard was proven by a test that fails without it.
- **Model cost.** Moved a grading step from a premium model to a lower-cost one only after the cheaper model passed a calibration set in which about half the answers are built to fail.
- **Prompt cache.** 96.5% of model input served from the prompt cache, so repeated context is not paid for twice.

SYSTEMS I BUILT

Production customer-service agent (live, private repo): tool-grounded pricing, output guards, reason-coded handoffs, 103-scenario live evaluation, low-cost grading model checked against a test set · **Release gate for LLM and RAG output** · **Agent loop with cost and step ceilings** and failures sorted into eight types · **LLM gateway with provider failover** · **Grounded support assistant** that rejects any answer citing a passage it was not given · **Policy-control evidence review** · local voice assistant that skips the model when a stored answer fits

All repositories, with the problem each one solves and who it helps: **dbhavery.dev/repositories**

EXPERIENCE

Founder, independent AI practice and angrynirds web and AI studio 2023 to present

Accountable for AI spend, model selection, system architecture, deployment and measured results across my businesses, including a live site with Stripe checkout and a production customer-service agent.

- Designed, built and operate a production customer-service agent that quotes prices only through tool calls against the price book and transfers unresolved cases to a person with a reason code and the transcript.
- Reduced incorrect answers from 3 to 0 on a 71-question evaluation of the live agent, and traced 21 of the 23 remaining handoffs to business policy that had not been set, which was escalated for decision.
- Established a 103-scenario release evaluation with a fixed answer-rate floor, and a CI gate that fails the build on LLM or RAG regression.
- Implemented production cost governance: output-token and chat-history caps, an 8-step limit per run, per-visitor and daily call limits, and a manual shutoff.

- Prioritized the lowest-cost path that passes evaluation: a flat-rate subscription before metered API calls, local open models before frontier models, and stored answers when retrieval confidence is high.
- Built an agent run budget that prices each call before execution, and an LLM gateway with cross-provider failover, circuit breakers, rate limits and an exact-match response cache.

Full experience, the results and the decisions behind them: **dbhavery.dev/experience**

Founder and Operator, small businesses 2017 to present

- Built and operated a direct-to-consumer grooming brand with full profit-and-loss responsibility, covering formulation, small-batch manufacturing, packaging, marketing, fulfillment and customer service.
- Designed the franchise economics and a nine-role operating platform for a fuel-delivery business (pre-launch), operated an investigations practice, and built Trucking Tutor, a CDL training site.

Line-haul Driver, Old Dominion Freight Line 2022 to present

- Operate Class A combination vehicles with hazmat, tanker and triples endorsements on multi-stop relay routes for a national less-than-truckload carrier.
- Coordinate in real time with dispatch and terminal teams under federal hours-of-service rules, with accountability for load integrity, DOT compliance and on-time performance.

Line Driver and Driver Trainer, Peninsula Truck Lines 2017 to 2021

- Ran line-haul and regional freight routes under DOT safety rules.
- Trained new drivers as a company-certified trainer: assessed skills, delivered road instruction and held authority to sign off new operators to drive unsupervised.

Fuel Tanker Driver, Alpha Transport 2012 to 2017

- Transported hazardous materials in tanker and oversized loads across Western US routes under FMCSA regulations.

SKILLS

AI operations	AI adoption, AI governance, AI platform and FinOps, token spend analysis, cost limits and budgets, cost per result, model selection, ROI reporting, workflow mapping, vendor and pricing models
Agents in production	Agentic AI, tool calling, Model Context Protocol (MCP), human-in-the-loop handoff, escalation, guardrails, kill switches
Evaluation and governance	Evals, regression gates in CI, calibrated LLM judges, RAG metrics, audit trails, license and data controls
Efficiency	Model routing, provider failover, response caching, prompt-cache use, local open models (Ollama, Qwen), cost and step ceilings
Engineering	Python, TypeScript, FastAPI, Next.js, Postgres, SQLite, Docker, Vercel, GitHub Actions, Claude, OpenAI-compatible APIs, Claude Code

EDUCATION AND CONTINUOUS AI LEARNING

Capella University, B.S. Computer Science (CeDiD 268P-KA6P-D3YN), GPA 3.95 | **Capella University**, Master of Business Administration, in progress

Continuous AI learning, 2023 to present. Anthropic certificate: Teaching the AI Fluency Framework, plus Anthropic Academy courses on Claude Code, MCP, and enterprise deployment on Bedrock and Vertex AI | **IBM**, AI Product Manager Professional Certificate | **DeepLearning.AI**, Generative AI with LLMs

Credentials: **dbhavery.dev/credentials**